*snapshots* for recovering RDS database instances. In this section, you'll learn how to use RDS snapshots to do the following:

- Configuring the retention period and time frame for automated snapshots
- Creating snapshots manually
- Restoring snapshots by starting new database instances based on a snapshot
- Copying a snapshot to another region for disaster recovery or relocation

## *10.3.1 Configuring automated snapshots*

The RDS database you started in section 10.1 can automatically create snapshots if the `BackupRetentionPeriod` is set to a value between `1` and `35`. This value indicates how many days the snapshot will be retained (the default is `1`). Automated snapshots are created once a day during the specified time frame. If no time frame is specified, RDS picks a random 30-minute time frame during the night. A new random time frame will be chosen each night.

Creating a snapshot requires all disk activity to be briefly frozen. Requests to the database may be delayed or even fail because of a timeout, so we recommend that you choose a time frame for the snapshot that has the least effect on applications and users (e.g., late at night). Automated snapshots are your backup in case something unexpected happens to your database. This could be a query that deletes all your data accidentally or a hardware failure that causes data loss.